

# **COPY-EDITING CASE STUDY**

## **Improving Clarity, Grammar, Tone, and Readability**

### **1. Case Study Overview**

This case study demonstrates a copy-editing process using self-created sample content. The purpose is to show how rough marketing and informational copy can be improved without changing the main idea.

The editing focuses on grammar, clarity, sentence structure, repetition, tone, word choice, and readability. The examples are designed to demonstrate practical editing decisions rather than simply correcting spelling mistakes.

All examples are self-directed portfolio exercises and do not represent paid client work.

### **2. Editing Process**

- Read the original copy to understand its purpose and intended audience.
- Identify grammar, punctuation, and spelling problems.
- Remove unnecessary words and repetition.
- Improve sentence structure and readability.
- Make the tone consistent with the intended audience.
- Check whether the main message is clear.
- Preserve the original meaning while making the copy stronger.
- Read the final version again to catch remaining problems.

### **3. Sample One — Product Marketing Copy**

#### **Original Version**

Our software is really amazing and it can help businesses to manage there projects in a much more better way because it has lots of features and everything that you need all in one place. You can use it for managing tasks, communication and deadlines and it also helps your team to be more productive and save more time.

#### **Edited Version**

Our software helps businesses manage projects more efficiently by bringing tasks, communication, and deadlines into one workspace. Teams can organize their work, track progress, and spend less time switching between different tools.

#### **What Was Improved**

- Corrected the spelling error in "there".
- Removed unnecessary words such as "really," "much more," and "lots of."
- Improved sentence structure.

- Reduced repetition around productivity and saving time.
- Made the main product benefit easier to understand.
- Changed the wording from vague claims to clearer practical benefits.

## **4. Sample Two — Website Introduction**

### **Original Version**

In today's modern world, technology is changing very quickly and businesses need to keep up with these changes otherwise they can be left behind. Our company provides solutions that are designed to help companies use technology in a better and more effective way so they can achieve their goals.

### **Edited Version**

Technology changes quickly, and businesses need practical ways to keep up. Our solutions help companies use technology more effectively so they can work toward their goals with greater clarity and efficiency.

### **What Was Improved**

- Removed the unnecessary phrase "today's modern world."
- Reduced repetition of the word "technology."
- Split the original idea into clearer sentences.
- Removed the overly dramatic phrase "left behind."
- Made the company message more direct.
- Improved readability while keeping the original meaning.

## **5. Sample Three — Social Media Copy**

### **Original Version**

Are you tired of wasting so much time every single day trying to organize your work? Well don't worry because our new productivity tool is here to help you get everything organized and make your life easier!!! Try it today and see how much better your work can become.

### **Edited Version**

Spending too much time organizing your work? Our productivity tool helps you keep tasks, deadlines, and priorities in one place. Try it today and spend less time organizing and more time getting work done.

### **What Was Improved**

- Removed unnecessary filler at the beginning.
- Reduced excessive punctuation.
- Removed the weak phrase "Well don't worry."
- Made the product benefit more specific.
- Improved the opening hook.

- Created a clearer call to action.

## **6. Sample Four — Professional Email**

### **Original Version**

Hi, I am writing this email because I wanted to ask you if you could please send me the information that we talked about before because I need it for the project and it would be really helpful if you can send it as soon as possible. Thank you for your help.

### **Edited Version**

Hi,

Could you please send me the information we discussed earlier? I need it for the project and would appreciate receiving it when you have a chance.

Thank you for your help.

### **What Was Improved**

- Removed the unnecessary opening sentence.
- Reduced the length of the main request.
- Improved sentence structure.
- Made the request polite without being repetitive.
- Added a cleaner email structure.

## **7. Sample Five — Blog Introduction**

### **Original Version**

There are many different ways that people can improve their productivity and there are many different productivity methods that people can use. In this article we are going to talk about some of the best productivity tips that can help you to become more productive in your everyday life.

### **Edited Version**

Improving productivity does not require a complicated system. A few practical changes to how you plan, prioritize, and manage your time can make everyday work easier. Here are several simple productivity practices you can try.

### **What Was Improved**

- Removed repeated use of "productivity."
- Created a stronger opening statement.
- Made the introduction more useful to the reader.
- Reduced unnecessary wording.
- Improved flow and readability.

## **8. Editing for Different Tones**

### **Professional Tone**

The message should be clear, respectful, and appropriate for business communication. Avoid unnecessary slang, exaggerated claims, and overly casual wording.

### **Friendly Tone**

The writing can feel more conversational while remaining clear. Shorter sentences and natural language can make the message feel approachable.

### **Persuasive Tone**

Persuasive copy should focus on the audience's problem, the relevant benefit, and the action the reader should take. It should remain specific rather than relying on exaggerated claims.

### **Technical Tone**

Technical content should prioritize accuracy and clarity. Complex concepts can be explained with simpler language when the audience does not need highly technical terminology.

## **9. Copy-Editing Checklist**

- Is the main message clear?
- Are there grammar or spelling errors?
- Are sentences unnecessarily long?
- Is there repeated information?
- Are there unnecessary words?
- Is the tone appropriate for the audience?
- Are claims clear and specific?
- Does the copy flow naturally?
- Is the call to action clear when one is needed?
- Does the final version preserve the original meaning?

## **10. Skills Demonstrated**

- Copy editing
- Proofreading
- Grammar correction
- Sentence restructuring
- Clarity improvement
- Conciseness
- Tone adjustment
- Marketing copy editing
- Social media copy editing
- Professional communication editing

- Technical and informational editing

## **11. Project Details**

- Project type: Self-directed copy-editing case study
- Role: Copy Editor
- Focus areas: Marketing copy, social media, professional communication, and informational content
- Skills demonstrated: Grammar, clarity, structure, conciseness, tone, readability, and proofreading
- The examples were created specifically for this portfolio to demonstrate editing ability.